

works and knowing your way around a terminal. But the web server we're looking at, i.e. Apache, runs just fine on Windows and there's absolutely no hiccups when you move your web site's source files from a Windows Apache installation to a Linux Apache installation.

If you really do want to get your hands dirty with the web server installation as well, then here's what you need:

- Operating System - Linux or Windows
 - Web server - Apache or NGINX
 - PHP version - 5.2.4 or greater
 - MySQL version - 5.0.15 or greater or any version of MariaDB
- (Optional) Apache mod_rewrite module (for clean URIs known as Permalinks)(Required for WordPress Multisite)

If possible, get PHP version 7 as WordPress performance nearly doubles with the latest PHP release.

If you're content with a slightly easier approach then get an easy to install web server stack like XAMPP. XAMPP stands for Cross-Platform (X), Apache (A), MariaDB (M), PHP (P) and Perl (P). The (M) used to stand for MySQL but as of late 2015, XAMPP moved on to MariaDB since it's a lot more open when it comes to open source contributions. Moreover, MariaDB performs significantly better than MySQL, however, with WordPress you're only going to see a performance increment of 3-5%. This scales to slightly higher numbers as your website grows.

Once you've installed XAMPP, you should know a few simple things about working with the software. For starters, XAMPP needs to be installed in a root directory of any partition. Inside the installation directory, you'll find a folder titled 'htdocs'. This is where all the files that need to be uploaded are stored. Once XAMPP is installed, you will find that the 'htdocs' folder is not empty. There exist a few pages that'll make it easier for you to configure the web server.

In a browser, type "127.0.0.1" or "localhost" and you should see a welcome page for phpMyAdmin. There are a few things you'll need to modify to get XAMPP working properly on your machine if your OS isn't a fresh install. This doesn't mean that you should format your drive just to install XAMPP, troubleshooting XAMPP errors are quite easy thanks to extensive documentation. However, there are two errors which are very common with XAMPP installs on older OS installations. This is because certain resources like open ports are limited. If you do come across an error message that mentions port 80 being unavailable then open [http.conf](http://httpd.apache.org/docs/2.4/configuring.html) and change port